

GROWTH AND DECAY

The complex effects of urbanization in a rapidly changing world

Urbanization (the population shift from rural areas to towns and cities) has been happening for centuries. However, the rate and extent of population shift has reached astonishing levels. Some Asian cities, such as Osaka, Jakarta, Mumbai, Seoul, and Beijing, already have populations of more than 20 million people.



What are the environmental consequences of urbanization on such a massive scale? One major effect of urbanization is the creation of "urban heat islands." Rural areas can remain cooler _____ the sun evaporating the moisture from the vegetation and the soil. However, in the cities there is much less soil and vegetation. _____, the sun beating on the buildings and roads _____ to an increase in temperatures. Additional heat from vehicles, factories, and cooling units also increases temperatures. This heat then _____ changes in local weather patterns.

Not only is there increased air pollution, but also higher levels of rainfall, _____ in flooding within the cities themselves and also downstream. Another _____ of urbanization is the increased consumption of food, energy, and durable goods. This has a far-reaching _____ on levels of natural resources.

causes impact ~~consequences~~ due to Consequently consequence leads resulting

34 ✓ CHECKLIST

⚙️ Dependent prepositions ☐

Aa Actions and consequences ☐

🧩 Changing sentence stress ☐